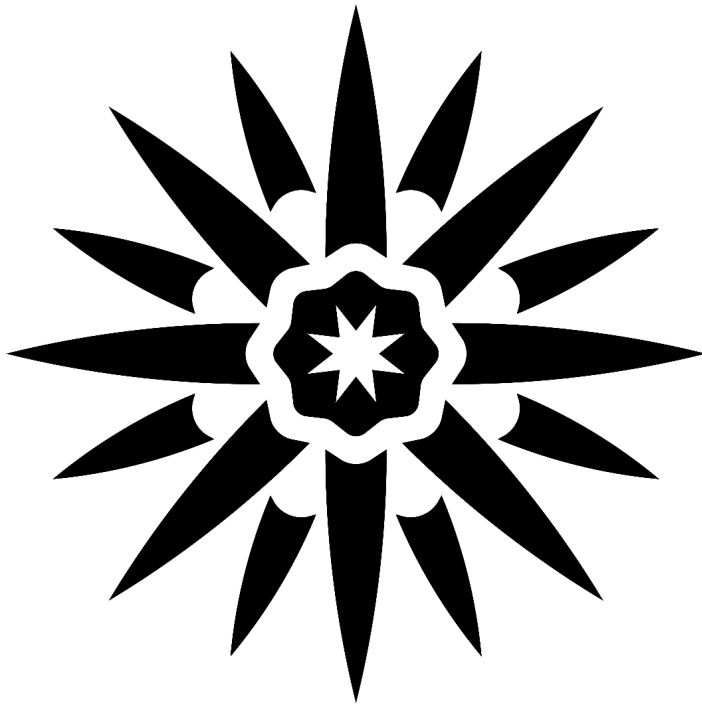




HELLENIC MOUNTAIN RACE

#HMR2026

RACE MANUAL

Preliminary information for 2026 riders

INTRODUCTION

The Hellenic Mountain Race is a serious undertaking that should not be underestimated. It takes place in an environment that can be as tough as it is beautiful. It requires not only the ability to ride big days back to back, but also knowledge and experience of being self-reliant in a remote mountain environment. Although it is definitely a race, your primary concern should always be your own safety. Riders will experience the natural beauty of Greece, and the warmth and generosity of its people. It is an experience that will hopefully stay with you a lifetime.

This race was primarily born out of my experiences racing the Transcontinental Race: an incredible adventure and now Mike Hall's legacy. He was personally involved in the Silk Road Mountain Race, the HMR's Kyrgyz sister race, prior to his tragic death during the Indian Pacific Wheel Race. He should have been a part of it. I hope that making it happen is a worthwhile contribution to the unsupported racing scene that he was instrumental in helping to create. He is sorely missed.

Nelson Trees - Founder

The Race Manual

Welcome to the race manual for HMR 2026. This edition of the Race Manual contains preliminary information for 2026 racers. It details the course, the environment and climate of the race. This document is your primary source of information about the Hellenic Mountain Race. **Future updates about the race will be shared via the SPORTITY app. You will be invited to download the app and join the HMR2026 channel when your race entry has been paid.** There will be very few email updates. If you don't install the app, you will be woefully unprepared for the race and will be missing a lot of key information.

The manual is the result of months of research and multiple scouting trips on the ground in Greece. We have put a lot of time and energy into making sure that everything you find here is accurate and up to date. We have ridden or driven every single kilometre of the route. Please take note, however, that things can change, mistakes do happen, and it is possible that there are minor discrepancies compared with the situation on the ground.

All information is provided in good faith and is believed to be correct at the time of writing. Whilst the general lines of the manual are unlikely to change, preparations for the race are ongoing and subject to modification until close to the start of the race. Please check **SPORTITY** before taking any actions based on the information given. Any major updates to the manual will be shared on **SPORTITY** only!

If in any doubt, do not hesitate to direct your specific questions to the race organisers via email only, at **race@hellenicmountainrace.cc**. Messages to the personal email or social media accounts of members of the HMR team concerning the race will not be systematically dealt with and may remain unanswered. We have launched a new forum for riders to share information and preparation with each other. You can [access the forum here](#) and will be required to create an account before you're able to access it. This is not a means of communication with the race organisation.

Why Greece?

If you are reading this manual, you most likely have some ideas about Greece and why it would make a good place for an unsupported bikepacking race. If not, let us tell you a little more about the destination before you embark on your adventure.

Greece is famous for its rich history and archeological heritage, stretching back thousands of years, its countless islands, pristine beaches, rich culinary tradition and so much more. What interests us though, is the lesser known, mountainous region to the northwest of the country. This is a part of the country that is dominated by the Pindus Mountains. It is here that we wish to take you on another kind of Greek adventure, far from the throngs of visitors and its more famous attractions. One that features steep, forested mountains, picturesque stone villages, endless gravel roads, ancient stone bridges and pathways, soaring peaks and open vistas. One where you will go many kilometres without seeing another human being, but when you do, will be welcomed with warmth and hospitality. One where the road is difficult but the reward is well worth it, be it the views or the generous portions of hearty, home cooked mountain food.

Race Route

The race route is hosted on Ride With GPS, the world's most trusted route planning and navigation platform, particularly suited to an adventure of this kind. Their platform offers powerful research and planning tools on desktop, tablet and mobile for both iOS and Android, and can connect with all popular devices. Ride with GPS is proud to be the official mapping partner of the 2026 Hellenic Mountain Race.

You can download the GPX directly from RWGPS as a single file. We will also share updated links to the final GPX in shorter GPS friendly sections closer to the start of the race. The resupply and other route information will be included directly in RWGPS as POIs (Points Of Interest).

You can find the route at this address:

<https://ridewithgps.com/routes/53223302>

We have taken great pains for the GPS track to be correct, but there may still be some slight deviations required due to changes on the ground from one season to the next or an error during recording. In the unlikely case that you come across a section where you feel the track is incorrect but see an obvious alternative, please make a note and tell us about the deviation you took and why. It will help us to make a fair decision should any action need to be taken at the end of the race. Another thing that we'd like to mention is that the quality of the road surface can vary a lot over time, even in the time since scouting. If the track follows a bad section of washboard but there is a smooth trail that runs parallel a few metres away, you may ride there. **This does not, however, give riders licence to follow any track they please.** We will be checking everyone's GPS data at the end of the race to make sure that no shortcuts were taken. Time penalties will be applied to riders who didn't follow the track. Anything more than a small deviation may lead to disqualification.

We have also checked out potential resupply points and have included those that we are reasonably certain to be in operation at the time of the race. There will likely be more available in reality. Nothing is 100% guaranteed, so whilst you should be able to rely on this information for your resupply strategy, always take extra precautions and build some margin into your plans. We encourage riders to do their own research on resupply and Greece in general.

Route Outline

The fourth edition of the Hellenic Mountain Race will follow a 920 kilometre route with 27,800m of vertical elevation gain. It will take riders from the picturesque stone village of Agios Athanasios near the foot of Kaimaktsalan/Kajmakčalan mountain to the picturesque, fortified, Venetian port town of Nafpaktos, on the Gulf of Corinth.

The route follows a mix of unpaved roads, tarmac, stone pathways and a handful of singletracks. The route is around 48% unpaved. There is also some hike a bike to allow us to take riders to a few particularly special places. Riders will need to validate their progress through the course at three staffed checkpoints: Smolikas, Melissourgi, and Karpenisi, before obtaining their final brevet card stamp in Nafpaktos.

You'll likely notice that there is rather a lot of climbing involved. Although the race takes place in a generally less remote setting than its two sister races in Kyrgyzstan and Morocco, this is certainly not going to be an easy race. If one had to compare it for overall difficulty, it would be somewhere between Atlas and Silk Road, with Silk Road still being the hardest.

The race will begin with a neutralised start through the centre of Agios Athanasios, before almost immediately heading up towards the first big challenge of the race: Kaimaktsalan/Kajmakčalan mountain. We begin with some tarmac, before the road gradually gets steeper and steeper up the mountain, turns to gravel and forces riders to get off and push their bike to the top. The chapel that commemorates the battle of Kajmakčalan between Serbian and Bulgarian forces during WWI has a spectacular view of Greece and North Macedonia. The descent will be vague at first criss-crossing the remains of WWI trenches before eventually joining the remains of a gravel road.

Riders will then make their way through a series of quiet tarmac and gravel roads to the picturesque town of Kastoria. They will ride around the peninsula that juts out into the lake before continuing on their way towards Smolikas and the first checkpoint of the race. Instead of riding around the mountain, we will take the direct route up the back and over it. It's around a 9 KM hike up to the top but the descent is well worth it, following one of the longest and best singletracks in Greece that was built and maintained by the passionate mountain bikers at Munti Smolikas refuge that will also host the first checkpoint of the race.

After Smolikas we take familiar paths but in reverse, there will be a short hike up to the top of Vikos Gorge and a number of old stone bridges and pathways on the way to Metsovo, one of the larger resupply points of the race.

The next section of the race route will take riders high into the Pindus range, leaving the forests behind for a while for more high altitude, barren mountains, open to the elements. There are some spectacular mountain roads on the way. They will finally reach the location of our second checkpoint : Melissourgi, at a refuge that is a wonderful retreat from the modern world, with a laid back and welcoming atmosphere. Riders will be able to rest up before tackling the next, remote section of the route. Immediately after leaving Checkpoint 2, riders will head up to one of the highest points in the race, with landscapes you would not expect in Greece. It looks a lot like Kyrgyzstan at times.

There won't be much in the way of civilization or resupply until Karpenisi. The route into this ski resort

town loops around the back of the mountain and up and over. It's likely the most difficult way to reach the town but also the most spectacular. The Checkpoint itself will likely again be at Hotel Elvetia, a family-run hotel in the town centre.

After Karpenisi, riders are on the home stretch down to Nafpaktos. They still have a number of big obstacles in the way though. The first of these is the climb up and over Diaselo Kaliakoudas pass. It's an improbable road that goes over, rather than around the mountain. What comes next is a section of gravel and tarmac in steep gorges that almost loops back on itself, here there will be views of the Monastery of Panagia Prousos.

The final challenge before a well deserved arrival at the finish line, will be to climb to the top of the mountain that dominates Nafpaktos. They'll then have one final downhill past the castle and into the town itself. The exact location of the finish line still needs to be confirmed, but will likely again be at Hotel Lepanto beach. There are plenty of amenities in town to relax and get some rest after the race.

Special credit is due to **Chrissa Zompoulou (@hesperiairisgraeca)** who graciously gave me plenty of recommendations and information on the Pindus Mountains and Greece in general. It is also well worth checking out her Pindus Traverse if you want more inspiration for where to go in these mountains.

Breakdown of the distance between checkpoints

Agios Athanasios to Smolikas : 237 KM / 6400m

Smolikas to Melissourgi : 247 km / 7000m

Melissourgi to Karpenisi : 244 km / 8000m

Karpenisi to Nafpaktos : 194 km / 6300m

Brief outline of resupply points

Distance (KM)				
ORIGIN	DESTINATION	TOTAL	LEG	Notes
Start	Achlada	48	48	Village shop
Achlada	Ammochori	63	15	Several shops & restaurants
Ammochori	Kastoria	130	67	Many shops, hotels, restaurants
Kastoria	Fourka	211	81	Two restaurants & a hotel
Fourka	Agia Paraskevi	222	11	Shop & hotel & restaurants
Agia Paraskevi	Pades	238	16	CP1: hot food, snacks, dormitory
Pades	Konitsa	267	29	Shops, restaurants, hotels
Konitsa	Klidonia	279	12	Petrol station shop
Kilidonia	Monodendri	314	35	Restaurants and hotels
Monodendri	Kipoi	323	9	Shop and restaurant

Kipoi	Metsovo	406	83	Hotels, restaurants & shops
Metsovo	Syrrako	458	52	Hotels, restaurants
Syrrako	Melissourgi	485	27	Hot food 24/7, snacks, dormitory
Melissourgi	Kastanea	540	55	Cafe
Kastania	Miliana	551	11	Restaurant & shop
Miliana	Piges	567	16	Restaurant
Piges	Raptopoulou	615	48	Restaurants & shops
Raptopoulou	Limeri	638	23	Restaurants & coffee shops
Limeri	Krentis	660	22	Petrol station shop
Krentis	Agia Triada	704	44	Hotel
Agia Triada	Karpenissi	729	25	CP3 hotels & restaurants
Karpenissi	Kastania	810	81	Restaurant possibly closed
Kastania	Thermo	874	64	Several shops & restaurants
Thermo	Nafaktos	922	48	FINISH

Toughest Sections & Notable Difficulties

KM14-29 Kaimaktsalan/Kajmakčalan: big steep climb, notorious for bad weather exposed with difficult to find track

KM222-238 hike up Smolikas mountain and singletrack down. The hike is tough and the descent is proper mountain biking

KM298-300 steep hike with no visible track. Quite short though

KM317-319 Stone paved pathway. Technical on the way down and hike back up, slippery when wet

KM484-510 After CP2 you will head out into the wilderness. High mountains, steep and sometimes damaged roads. If the weather turns, it won't be easy.

KM673-KM678 Steep hike up from bridge to main road

KM704-KM718 Big tarmac climb to Karpenisi

KM775-KM780 Big climb up and over Kaliakoudas

KM896-906 the final challenge of the race: a massive climb to the top of the mountain overlooking Nafaktos

Race Categories

The Hellenic Mountain Race is primarily designed as a solo challenge, but to make it more accessible to less experienced riders or those that want to share the experience, we have also included a pairs category. We will not be accepting teams or groups of more than two riders to enter the race.

The Hellenic Mountain Race may be raced as a **SOLO** rider or as part of a **PAIR**. These will be the two finishing categories. The final race rankings will reflect these two categories with finishing times and positions in these categories only. For more information on how this will work, head to the rules section further down in this race manual.

Solo riders are expected to be entirely self-sufficient. They must not receive any outside assistance, be that private resupply, navigation information, information on where they are in the race rankings, drafting other riders, etc. The same rules apply for pairs riders but to the pair as a whole. They are allowed to assist and support each other within the pair, but the pair as a whole cannot receive any assistance from outside of the pair. If you have any doubts as to what constitutes outside assistance and private resupply, we are happy to answer any of your questions.

We feel that a little further clarification can be helpful when it comes to solo racers riding together. We don't want to discourage people riding together intermittently and sharing the experience because of a fear of being declassified or disqualified. At the same time, this is a race, and the rules need to be fair to riders that truly ride the entire route solo. We're not going to quantify precisely how much time can be spent with another rider before it constitutes riding as a pair. Essentially, if you ride with someone, it should be because you happen to be riding at the same pace at that time. What you should not be doing is the following: planning to sleep in the same place, waiting for each other, etc. for days on end.

*Please note that you are only allowed to finish in the general classification in the same category as you started in. For instance solo riders cannot finish as a pair if they decide to team up in the middle of the race. The same applies if a Pairs rider finishes without their partner. In both cases, riders will be given a finishing time, but will be removed from the general classification.

Race Coverage and Rider Updates

There will be three main channels for spectators to follow the race. First and foremost will be the Race Map and rider 'dots'; the go to resource for your family, friends and followers to check on your progress. We expect many an hour will be spent by dot watchers poring over the race map to see how the dots are progressing.

We will also be posting daily images on our social media channels. Look out for one of our two control cars as they make their way along the race route on the lookout for riders. We may also be placing photographers in some pretty remote and hard to reach spots, so keep an eye out, you never know when they might come across you.

Last but not least, we will be producing a daily podcast that will focus more on the middle and rear of the race, telling the stories of those who tend to get a little less attention in these kinds of races.

In addition to this, we will be keeping an eye on your social media. While a lot of the coverage will go to those at the sharp end of the race, our control cars will be spread throughout the field and we will do our best to post updates on as many riders as possible, regardless of where they are in the race standings. It's not all about winning.

The official hashtag for this edition of the race is **#HMR2026**

In addition to this, each rider will also be encouraged to use a personal hashtag unique to them in this edition of the race. This will be comprised of the official hashtag above and the cap number given in 3 digits, for example: **#HMR2026cap001**

This will allow us and your followers to easily see a feed of all your updates across various platforms as well as those who are posting about you. Cap numbers will be allocated shortly before the start of the race.

While the race is in progress, the ways to get in touch with us will be printed on your Brevet Card and these will include:

Email: **race@hellenicmountainrace.cc**

SMS / Helpline: **TBC**

Trackers: SOS/Assistance: ***The use of the tracker buttons has precise instructions that must be strictly adhered to, see details lower down in this manual***

Hellenic Mountain Race will be making updates via the following channels:

Instagram: [instagram.com/hellenicmountainrace](https://www.instagram.com/hellenicmountainrace)

Our Race Podcast: [Listen on Spotify](#) | [Listen on Apple Podcasts](#)

Facebook page: [facebook.com/hellenicmountainrace](https://www.facebook.com/hellenicmountainrace)

Our YouTube Channel: [youtube.com/@themountainraces](https://www.youtube.com/@themountainraces)

Next of kin following the race

The primary means of following the race will be the race map and the dots. However, please remember that the information provided by the system is not infallible. As with other events where the system is used, there may be periods where tracking is incomplete or less than 100% reliable. There can be tracker failures and issues with tracker reliability. The race organisation has a number of designated "Dotwatchers", but welcomes information from those who are also watching their loved ones. It is natural for people, especially friends and family, to worry about riders when their tracker stops moving for any length of time. Please do not panic as there are any number of reasons why this could be the case. If you are particularly concerned, you can send an email to **race@hellenicmountainrace.cc**, with a rider cap number and **TRACKING** in the title. The person on duty at HQ, can then act accordingly and compare with other data from the control cars and latest dotwatching logs. We will do our best to get

back to you in a timely manner and check on riders as necessary, but please understand that we are very busy during this time.

Finally, for followers' peace of mind, don't forget that whilst the HMR is held in a wild and remote location, the fact that all riders follow the same route, will ensure that if a rider does encounter a problem, another rider will soon pass the same way. The control cars will be spread out amongst the field of riders and travelling along the same route also. Finally, remember that there are usually locals about, even in the most seemingly remote parts of the country.

Scratching from the Race

If you end up in the situation where, for one reason or another, you cannot continue with your race, and wish to drop out or 'scratch' from the race please get in touch with us as soon as possible by sending an email to race@hellenicmountainrace.cc or sending us a message on the official whatsapp number. Include in your email or message as much information as possible regarding the circumstances of your withdrawal from the race, including your full name and race number. Please don't just scratch and leave the race without telling us anything. A rider who has scratched and turned off their tracker looks exactly the same on the map as someone who's tracker isn't working but is still racing or worse, is in trouble.

Note that all riders are welcome to celebrate with us at the finish regardless of how they get there. If you scratch from the race you are responsible for your onward travel to the destination you choose.

"Never scratch at night" is good advice from accomplished endurance racers. That is to say always wait until morning to make any big decisions, things have a habit of looking a lot better after a night's sleep. That advice has saved many a successful race campaign, including my own.
- MIKE HALL

Contact with HMR during the race

HMR will be operating a mobile Race Headquarters (HQ), that will function 24/7 during the race period and will be best equipped to respond to any urgent enquiries. The official race email, **race@hellenicmountainrace.cc** is the best way to get in touch with staff at race HQ. HMR staff will then be able to quickly get in touch with the teams out in the field and pass on information as required to best respond to any situations that arise. Details of how to get in touch with the HQ will also be printed on the Brevet cards that will be given to riders at registration the day before the start of the race.

For the duration of the race, the main assets that HMR will have in the field are the three control cars that will be travelling along the race route. These will likely be the most expedient means of checking on a rider and responding to any situations that arise.

Prior to the race we will be getting in touch with the emergency contact that riders provided during the application procedure with more information on how best to get in touch with HMR. We will also provide a brief guide on what is to be expected as a first time dot watcher and avoid any unnecessary worries caused by such issues as intermittent tracking.

It is crucial for riders and their next of kin to understand before entering the race that informing your next of kin of any relevant information may well be the only action that HMR are able to perform in the event of an accident. Riders need to understand that they are fully self-reliant and responsible for themselves and it simply may not be possible for HMR to provide any assistance, which therefore carries no obligation. Riders will need to sign the Rider Agreement prior to their participation in the race being accepted. It will be provided to them online before the start of the race.

Registration and Race Start

Registration

Friday 22nd May 9 AM - 4 PM

Location : Agios Athanasios

ADDRESS : TBC

Coordinates : TBC

As public transport to Agios Athanasios is non-existent we plan to organise a transfer from Thessaloniki to the registration location on Friday morning. We will likely leave Thessaloniki bright and early at 7AM and arrive in Agios Athanasios around 9AM and then start registration. We've also talked to the mayor of Agios Athanasios to be sure that enough hotels and restaurants will be open on the day of registration. More information will be shared on this later.

Documents for registration will be uploaded on a portal provided by our entry system partner, **Eventrac**, around a month prior to the start of the race. We recommend that you carry a copy of your insurance documents with you during the race.

Tracker deposit payment will be made available online in April through stripe, allowing for quicker registration. Your deposit payment will also be reimbursed using stripe when you return your tracker. This will be possible at the finish line in Nafaktos until it closes at midnight on Saturday the 30th of May (the evening of the party).

When you arrive, give your name at the desk and follow our volunteers' directions. We will check your records and call you up to take care of any parts of the process we need you to complete. You can then take your tracker and various goodies.

If you have your own tracker please ensure you have an active subscription in time for the race and turn it on and test it after registration. We will have checked all trackers to ensure they have registered a pre-race position and they are working properly but please also do so yourself. If you fail to test the tracker we may not get a chance to check for errors before you leave and you may experience tracking problems.

Bike Box & Bag Transfer

We will be providing a free bike box & bag transfer service for riders, included in your entry fee. You will be able to leave your bike box or bag and one small bag of personal items with us at registration which we'll then transport to the finish line for you. The idea is for you to have a change of clothes and a few extra belongings that you wouldn't want to carry during the race itself. Although the bags will be kept in a secure place, please do not leave any valuables to avoid any risk of lost items.

Bike Boxes

Bike boxes will be transferred from Agios Athanasios to the finish line **at the end of registration on the**

22nd of May. You will be able to drop off your box during registration. **Cardboard bike boxes must be provided flattened.** Your boxes should be **EMPTY**. We will not accept boxes with additional personal belongings.

Bags

If you want to leave a small bag with us for transport to the finish line, please do so in the morning just before the start. Your bag must be less than 40x25x20cm. **We will not accept bigger bags.** You will need to make your way to the finish line to pick up your belongings. Nothing will be left at the registration hotel.

Rider Briefings

The rider briefings will take place in Agios Athanasios at (**Exact location TBC**) at **5PM on the 22nd of May**. This briefing is **mandatory for all riders** and will either confirm or update you on the information provided in this manual. Brevet cards are your official record of race times and may only be issued at the rider briefings, so make sure you attend. Without a Brevet Card, you may not appear on the race results. **You MUST attend or you will not be allowed to race.**

HMR Control and Media Crew on the Road

Hellenic Mountain Race will be out in the field for the duration of the race in our three official control cars with photographers, a videographer and a podcaster. We will also be catching up with riders to talk with them for the race podcast that will be published every day throughout the race. Our media teams will have been briefed to capture the race but not get in your way. Do please feel free to chat with us of course. Remember that if you want to be left alone and get on with things though, you are under no obligation to stop.

HMR Volunteers at Control Points

Please be mindful that most of the people you will meet at the start, finish and control points will be volunteers who are giving their time to make all this possible. Please be kind and courteous to all volunteers, no matter how tired you are, without these people there would be no race.

Race Start : Agios Athanasios



Location : TBC

Coordinates: TBC

Race Starts: Saturday 23rd May 09:00 (GMT+1) (Please arrive 30 minutes before this time)

For the fourth edition of the race, we start in Agios Athanasios, the exact location still needs to be confirmed but it will likely be from the abandoned primary school. Please be at the start line, all packed and ready to go at least 30 minutes before the official start. Head to the GPS coordinates written above and look out for signage and volunteers waiting to welcome you for the start of the race.

The Checkpoints

There will be three mandatory checkpoints in Hellenic Mountain Race 2026. They will begin operation at the arrival of the first rider and they will close as indicated below. Checkpoints are used as a means of confirming the passage of race participants along the route both as proof of full participation and as a safety check for the organisers to confirm the physical location (and condition) of participants compared to the satellite tracking data.

Passage through each checkpoint is confirmed by a stamp by the duty HMR representative in your brevet card. Each checkpoint is located where there are certain resources or services. In accordance with the principles of unsupported racing, any services are limited to those generally commercially available. The race organisers and volunteers may provide you with information at their discretion. The checkpoints are the best place for friends, families and supporters to cheer on riders should they decide to do so. We recommend that anyone coming out to support riders get in touch with HMR beforehand.

Checkpoint Cut-offs

HMR will not be operating hard cut-offs for the race checkpoints. You will be free to continue on your way around the race course even if you are outside the time frame of the race. You will be able to self validate using a recognisable photograph at the checkpoint location. However, please be aware that if you are outside the checkpoint closing times HMR will not be in a position to provide even the most basic assistance should you require it.

Operating Hours (Local Times)

The checkpoints will be open 24 hours, but please do take care to consider others when arriving outside normal daytime hours.

CP1: Smolikas



Control: Munti Smolikas (TBC)

Coordinates: 40.0399, 20.9098

Closes: Tuesday 26th May at 12PM (midnight) (GMT +1)

Distance from start: 247 Kilometres

A big hike up and singletrack down to the Munti Smolikas refuge. They did a great job last year and we expect they will be even better prepared this time around. Be sure to say hi to Hector at the refuge.

Food & Accommodation

Details are still to be confirmed but there will be food, drinks and snacks available. It will likely be spaghetti bolognese all night with a veggie option.

CP2: Melissourgi



Control: Melissourgiotiko Mountain Refuge

Coordinates: 39.5051, 21.1415

Closes: Wednesday 28th May at 12PM (midnight) (GMT+1)

Distance from start: 484 Kilometres

This charming mountain refuge lies on the outskirts of Melissourgi, at the foothills of some seriously wild mountains. It's got a great atmosphere and should be the perfect place to rest up and recharge before heading out on some of the highest and most exposed kilometres of the race route.

Food & Accommodation

The refuge is not that big, so accommodation will be limited. Last year we had a dedicated dorm room for riders on a first come, first served basis. The food and atmosphere were perfect last year and we expect it to be a highlight again, with riders struggling to leave and head up the mountain. There will be big portions of food 24/7 with vegetarian options available.

CP3: Karpenissi



Control: Hotel Elevetia (TBC)

Coordinates: 38.9146, 21.7947

Closes: Friday 30th May 12:00 (noon) (GMT +1)

Distance from start: 729 Kilometres

Karpenisi is the regional capital of Evrytania and a popular winter tourism destination. It boasts a ski resort atop the mountain that dominates the town. We will of course reach the checkpoint by climbing up and over the mountain and dropping down into the town itself via a winding tarmac road. There is a mountain charm to its streets, with plenty of hearty local food to warm up on a cold winter's evening. It's one of the biggest resupply points on route. Make the most of it before heading south as there isn't much more before the finish line!

Food & Accommodation

The hotel itself is quite large but there are plenty of other hotels in town though if it does fill up. There is no food at the hotel itself but there are plenty of options in town. The gyros place opposite is open relatively late. There is no food 24/7 at the checkpoint so keep this in mind if arriving late.

Finish: Nafpaktos



Finish Line: Lepanto Beach Hotel (TBC)

Coordinates: 38.3913, 21.8380 (TBC)

Closes: Saturday 30th May at 12PM (GMT+1) (midnight on the evening of the party)

Distance from start: 922 km

Nafpaktos is a charming little town at the entrance to the Corinthian Gulf. It is famous for its picturesque fortified port and castle. Today it is a popular tourist destination, mainly amongst locals. It's not so big as to get lost, but big enough that there is all you could possibly need for a few days resting after a few hundred kilometres on the bike. There are plenty of tavernas in the old port offering delicious food and plentiful drinks. We hope it will make the perfect finish line for the race. The exact location of the finish line still needs to be confirmed but is likely to be at Lepanto Beach Hotel. There are plenty of other accommodation options in town.

Finisher's Party

There will be drinks, back-slapping and some speeches and small prizes on Saturday 30th of May from 9pm until late. It'll be the opportunity to chill out, exchange stories from the road and generally recover from the ride.

Shuttle back to Athens

Once registration is complete, we will send out a form to ask you all if you would be interested in transport for you and your bike back to Athens. Once we have numbers, we will look into the feasibility and cost of offering this service. Otherwise, there is a public coach station in Nafpaktos and a limited number of bikes can be taken on each bus. Please do your research and confirm with the bus companies before booking.

Safety throughout the Race

Entering this race should not be taken lightly, it is a serious undertaking that will require a high level of fitness, extensive preparation and carefully selected equipment. As the organisers, safety is our primary concern. The vast majority of the route is on 4x4 tracks or gravel roads with very little traffic. Nonetheless, there are sections where you will not be alone on the road and as we have seen from the recent tragedies in our community, sharing the road with cars can be dangerous. Just because you haven't seen any cars on the road, don't forget that there still are some. **Always stay on the right side of the road, especially when you have no visibility around corners.**

The entire route has been checked and a full risk assessment conducted. It shall also be taken as a clear indication to riders that the HMR is an ultra endurance bike packing race that pushes the boundaries of races of this type and each and every participant must pay particular attention to his/her race preparations. Your bike should be appropriate for the terrain and in perfect working condition. Lights and brakes shall be in full working order. Use your lights in all conditions of darkness or reduced visibility.

Almost the entire race takes place in a remote mountain environment. **We will check your equipment to ensure that you have everything on the mandatory equipment list.** There are long stretches of the route where there is no shelter, no habitation, and no services of any kind available to compensate for poor preparation or inadequate equipment. Riders are advised to be particularly vigilant with regard to the additional consequences of exhaustion, sleep deprivation and extremes of temperature, where they may be completely alone for substantial periods during the race.

It is compulsory to wear a helmet compliant with EN1078 at all times when riding during the event. Finally, take care to keep your insurance, identification and next of kin contact documents with you in a safe, dry place at all times.

Warnings about riding the Hellenic Mountain Race

As we have previously stated, entering into this race is a serious undertaking. It takes place in a remote area of a country where services and infrastructure are more limited than what you may be used to. This is part of the attraction of the race, but you must also understand the risks that this entails. We will go over some of the major risks that are inherent with taking part in this adventure below.

Terrain

The race takes part in serious, mountainous terrain. There may not be the altitude of other places in the world, but it is nonetheless a difficult place to ride a bike. The tracks vary from smooth tarmac to unrideably steep trails. It is almost all rideable but the going will be tough. The hike a bike sections will be shorter than in SRMR but there will still be many points when you'll need to get off the bike and push. There are no river crossings worth noting.

Climate and Weather Conditions

Conditions in the Pindus Mountains in May should generally be good with average temperatures between 5 and 30 degrees celsius. Not too hot and not too cold. That being said, these are still mountains and we do reach altitudes of up to 2000m. The weather can be unpredictable. During scouting there was rain and several storms. In the previous editions of the race we've seen plenty of rain. Your wet weather gear may turn out to be crucial.

Emergency and medical services

Due to the remoteness of some sections of the race and the lack of inhabitants who live out here, help will take a long time to arrive. It may take hours or even days for emergency services to reach you, even with the SPOT trackers that all riders are required to carry. Ride conservatively and wear appropriate clothing to avoid needing assistance in the first place.

Resupply

Due to the wild and remote nature of some sections of the route, resupply will be one of the major challenges that you will face to remain safe and ride efficiently. Information on resupply points that we consider are reasonably certain to be in operation at the time of the race is provided in this manual. Please be warned, that this information is for guidance only. There are also no doubt more potential resupply points, so do your own research. It is good policy to keep some reserves in case you are unable to get resupply. Opening hours may also be a problem from some resupply points. The big positive in Greece is that there are often stone fountains that provide ground water along the road. Water should generally not be a problem. I would still recommend a minimum of 2L carrying capacity.

Wildlife

Due to the remote nature of the route, you may encounter wildlife during the race. During scouting Nelson saw two bears, some wild boar and several mountain goats. The bears quickly made an exit (unfortunately before allowing themselves to be captured on film).

Shepherd Dogs

This is likely the biggest potential danger on the route. Shepherd dogs up in the mountains are often left alone with their flocks and are known to be aggressive and very protective of their flock and territory. Our basic advice is to slow down and get off the bicycle if necessary, keeping it between you and the dog(s).

Loud noises and making as if to pick up a rock works well to calm them down. Take your time. Trying to outrun the dogs is a risky proposition unless you are absolutely certain you will be faster. Actually throwing rocks as a last resort can help. We luckily haven't had any serious incidents during the race, but a rider did get bitten on the way to the start and was unable to race. Be very careful.

Mandatory equipment list

There will be a mandatory equipment list for all participants in the race. We will keep this as short as possible. It is essentially a minimum checklist to make sure that you do not head out into remote areas with inadequate equipment.

- Front and Rear lights
- Helmet
- Basic first aid kit: this includes bandages, antiseptic/sterile wipes, medication
- Suitable sleeping system. We won't be enforcing a specific temperature rating for each piece of equipment, but rather, you should have with you equipment to be comfortable sleeping at 5°C.
- Down jacket or synthetic equivalent. Something warm if you get stuck in cold/wet weather.
- Waterproof jacket and trousers
- Survival blanket: they're super light and could prove invaluable in an emergency.
- Gloves: These are to protect you from the weather rather than cycling specific. They should be warm and at least water resistant.

Bike recommendations

There are a number of bike options that would all be solid choices for this race. There are few extremely technical sections but you will benefit from wider tyres, flat bars and mountain bike geometry on the rougher sections and on descents. When it gets very tough, you probably won't be able to ride, regardless of the bike you choose.

I think the ideal bike is something fast and light with at least 2.0" tyres. When it comes down to it, it will depend on you: your bike handling skills, how much comfort you need for long days in the saddle, and the bike that you have available. What I would recommend though is low gearing, with, at the very least, a 1 to 1 ratio for your lowest gear. There are some steep, steep sections. You may well also want to go with front suspension, but it is not required. The route is closer to a gravel event than either of the other races in the Mountain Race series but it's still no walk in the park. I would personally ride a hardtail mountain bike on this route (I don't own a gravel bike!).

Emergency Situations

Regardless of how competitive you are or where you stand in the race rankings, safety should always be your primary concern. Please think carefully about your personal safety at all times and avoid unnecessary risks. Many sections of the race route are remote and difficult to access. Help will most likely take hours to arrive at the best of times.

In the event that you do find yourself in a life threatening situation, check your spot tracker and activate the SOS function. If you are within cellular reception, please call us immediately. Contact information will be given during the rider briefings and will be printed on your brevet card. If none of these options are available to you, due to tracker malfunction, etc. you will need to find your own assistance.

We do not want to discourage people from using the SOS function on their tracker, but please know that we take distress signals very seriously and getting help to the location of the incident often requires massive coordination by the organisation. Please think carefully before using this function and **use the SOS only in a life threatening situation**. We will not be able to establish the reason for the SOS call until someone is physically on location.

We will have a team of Dot Watchers who will be monitoring your track very carefully for the duration of the race and if we spot something unusual, we will likely make sure things are okay. We will put systems in place to ensure that in the event that something happens to a rider, but that they are unable to notify HMR, there will still be a response. An analysis will be made of the conditions before the period of inactivity: terrain, speed, location, etc. to judge the probability that there is an issue and react accordingly.

Next of Kin

All riders are required to give details of their next of kin, so that they can be contacted if HMR become aware of any incidents or accidents involving riders. Next of kin will be contacted before the race and notified that they have been nominated as a racer's point of contact. They will also be advised of some of the more important details of the rider agreement which riders have signed, the responsibilities of the riders, and the limited obligations of HMR. They will also be given information on how to follow the race and what to expect as it unfolds.

HMR advise that riders discuss their entry into the race with their next of kin well in advance of the event. Their next of kin should understand that the rider is taking full responsibility for their ride and is fully aware that they won't be getting any assistance. This discussion is key to the avoidance of any misunderstanding by participants or their next of kin.

Due to the nature of the event and the distribution of riders along the course, HMR cannot provide emergency rescue to riders. Our commitment is to help coordinate the best response possible to any incident and notify next of kin as soon as we can, once we are aware of an incident and provide them with as much information as possible. In the event of an incident, HMR will not make any public statements without first contacting next of kin, verifying information and obtaining their permission.

Registration Documents / Checklist

Documents to be brought with you in person to registration

Photo ID - For example passport / driver's licence / ID card to prove it is you and so no imposter can steal your place on the starting line.

Documents to be uploaded online via the dedicated portal a month ahead of the start

Doctor's Note - We must ask you to provide a medical note signed by your doctor to certify that you are in good physical health to undertake the demands of the event. The note must bear the name and marks of a traceable doctor's practice, confirm that there are no known health reasons that you should not participate and mention the Atlas Mountain Race by name.

We will be providing a document that we recommend you bring with you when you visit your doctor for the purpose of obtaining a doctor's note. It will provide a brief checklist of topics that it could be useful to discuss with your doctor (these are recommendations but not mandatory). This document can be found at the end of this manual but will also be sent to all riders separately.

Insurance - you need to have insurance that will cover extraction, medical costs in Greece and repatriation.

Satellite Tracking

Satellite tracking is included within the entry fee. SPOT personal satellite trackers will be available for collection all day on Friday and their use demonstrated.

Private SPOT trackers

Private trackers are welcome and encouraged, there is a £40 discount for riders with their own device.

If you wish to use your own tracker we will require your share page URL and ESN number - there will be a form available to submit this on or before race day.

(note that a Garmin style GPS device is not the same as a SPOT tracker and does not perform the same function. For your SPOT you will also need an active service plan).

Prior to the start of the race you will also need to change the emergency contacts on your findmespot page to those specified by HMR, this will ensure that emergency services are coordinated as quickly as possible in case of emergency. Details on how to do this and the contacts to use will be sent to riders separately by email.

All racers who do not have their own tracker will be supplied with one by HMR. It is the rider's responsibility to keep this active and replace batteries as necessary. In the event that your tracker is not active for any period of time then riders may be asked to present other evidence to confirm their ride in order to get a valid time and place in the general classification. All finishers in the top 10 will need their ride verified by a tracker.

HMR rental devices: SPOT Generation IV



Tracker Deposit

A refundable deposit of £200 against loss or damage will be required for each tracker online via Paypal. Your deposit will be returned to you via Paypal once you have returned the tracker.

Tracker Instructions

Mounting device. Ensure the tracker has the SPOT logo facing up with a clear view of the sky, this ensures the best satellite coverage. The ideal spot is up higher and/or away from you, it can be placed at the top of a bag (the right way up) and transmit through the fabric but it shouldn't be under other equipment.

Turn on. Press and hold the Power button at the top left to turn on; lights will illuminate. THEN Start tracking. Please leave your tracker on for the duration of the race. It will switch into power saving mode when you are not moving so there is no need to ever switch it off. This will prevent the risk of accidentally forgetting to turn it back on, causing concern from HMR and loved ones alike.

Start tracking. Press and hold the Track (footprint) button until the light illuminates green. The device can be left on continuously, it is motion activated so will use very little battery when stopped.

Turn off. Press and hold the Power button until the Power light blinks rapidly.

OK button. For HMR 2026 you will be able to use the OK button in two situations: at the end of the day to let us know that you have stopped for the night; and when you are stopped or plan to stop for more than 6 hours. This will let us and our dotwatching team know that there is nothing for us to worry about during a prolonged break. To ensure the message gets through, leave it on under a clear sky for 20 minutes.

Help button. (hand icon) The help button will not be used in HMR 2026.

Custom Message Button. (text message icon) We will not be using the Custom Message button for HMR 2026

SOS button. SPOT's S.O.S. function should only be used for critical, life-threatening situations. Pressing the S.O.S. button sends an alert directly to Race HQ and local authorities, who will work together to coordinate an emergency rescue as soon as possible. As stated elsewhere in this manual, please be aware that the response time may be significant, with help possibly many hours away.

Waterproof. The device is waterproof to a depth of 1 metre for 30 minutes. For more detailed information, visit www.findmespot.com and view their "SPOT Gen3 user guide"

The rules

Introduction & Clarification of the Rules

When it came to deciding the rules of the HMR for inclusion in the fourth edition of the race manual, I first had a look at how other unsupported races do things, and the slight differences that exist in the letter of the law for each of them. They all share the same general principles but there is some variation both in the rules that are spelled out and how strictly they are applied. In the end, I based the rules on the system that Mike Hall developed for the last edition of the Transcontinental that he was involved in before his tragic death. He was at the forefront of developing our sport and worked tirelessly to improve and update things every year, learning from the experience of putting on one of the leading unsupported races. From personal experience, I can say that the rules that he developed worked very well in the context of the Transcontinental. The addition of the distinction between a completion and category finish added another level of sophistication to distinguish between true solo finishes and riders who completed the challenge but who could not truly say that they finished the race entirely unsupported. I think that there is real value in retaining this system. It allowed for two categories of finishers, one a little more lenient that made the race more accessible, and the other that ensured that those going for the win would need to really do things entirely by themselves. Just to reiterate, here is the distinction between these two categories as defined below:

*If all **RULES** given below are observed then riders are awarded a **COMPLETION** and are included in the register of **arrivals** which will be listed in time order. Where any reasonable doubt may exist and there is no evidence of a rule breach, then benefit of such doubt is given to the rider.*

*If, as above, all **RULES** are observed **AND** the conditions for **QUALIFICATION** below are met then riders will be awarded a **CATEGORY FINISH** and be given a finishing position in the **general classification** for solo or pairs as well as being listed in the register of **arrivals**. Where any reasonable doubt may exist and there is no evidence of qualification then the rider will need to prove it.*

However, there are also some notable differences between the Transcontinental and the Hellenic Mountain Race. It is more difficult navigating the grey areas between private and commercially available resupply. What is acceptable 'trail magic' and what is outside resupply that will give one rider an advantage over another? Where does the line fall between positive interaction with locals and relying on them to complete your ride? When the nearest bike shop is back at the start of the route, several hundred kilometres away, and a rider's pump is broken through no fault of their own, should that mean the end of their ride or of anyone who stops to help? How do we distinguish between these different scenarios in a way that holds riders to a high standard of self-sufficiency and ensures an even playing field while still being realistic? Following the rules is largely self-policed and riders need to feel that they can discuss any issues that they had during their ride.

From the very first edition of the HMR we need a set of rules that best reflects the reality on the ground while respecting the spirit and heritage of our sport. No doubt we will build on these rules and adapt them as we learn more about the realities of the race in future editions.

The first topic to address is the interaction between riders and locals outside of clear commercial resupply situations. In a country with a proud tradition of hospitality, it would be a real shame not to allow

riders to accept offers of this kind. However, allowing riders to accept offers of food, drink and even shelter, does create a lot of possibilities for contentious situations.

The principle that riders shall follow is this: they may accept legitimate, unplanned offers of drink, food or shelter but must not go looking for it. Any help received must not be solicited in any way. It's the difference between stopping for a shepherd who waves you over and going off route and asking for something. I absolutely do not want to hear of riders knocking on doors or going out of their way to get help from locals. Riders should not be counting on the support of locals to get them through a remote section. They should be fully self-sufficient and any offer from locals should be an opportunity for interaction and positive experiences rather than a means of carrying less supplies or gaining any kind of advantage. If they do get themselves into a situation where they came to depend on a local to get them through it, then they should tell us about it and explain the circumstances.

What this means is that we will be adding one more rule for the second edition of the HMR, on a trial basis.

- **Riders must not solicit any form of private resupply from locals on the race route, any such interaction must be freely offered and unplanned.**

For riders who are pursuing a category finish (a requirement for contesting the overall win), the same distinction when it comes to the burden of proof as in other situations will be observed. Unlike with a simple completion, where we will assume that anything offered by locals was indeed in good faith, riders seeking a spot in the general classification will need to prove that it was the case if any doubts arise. It will not necessarily be easy to do so, meaning that there is a certain risk involved. We recommend you document any of these situations to ensure that there is no doubt. Take some pictures, make a video, whatever you feel can help. If you want to be absolutely certain that no questions arise, it may be best to avoid the more substantial offers of hospitality such as shelter or a full meal.

The second main topic that requires some discussion is assistance between riders. There has been quite a lot of debate about what constitutes outside assistance between riders, particularly for mechanical problems. This was especially true for relatively minor infractions such as lending someone a pump. The view that we have adopted for the HMR is that any assistance received from another rider means that you will not be disqualified but you will be eligible for a completion only. The assisted rider will not be able to receive a spot in the general classification. We will also slightly relax the rule regarding the rider doing the assisting also being penalised. Helping another rider will not affect their standing in the race. This makes the HMR somewhat more lenient than the Transcontinental but I think that in the context of Greece, where a mechanical can mean not only the end of your race but also the ride, it is justified.

Finally, I would also like to clarify what to do if you suffer a mechanical that you are unable to fix yourself or any other issue that requires a hasty retreat towards civilisation not under your own power. We will allow you to hitch or pay for a lift out, but also back, as the distances involved are such that riding back to the spot where you had the issue would essentially mean the end of your race. However you get back to where you were, it won't be easy and it will cost you a lot of time. If you do end up needing to do this, we expect you to document the exact location where you were picked up and make sure that you return

precisely to the same spot. The best solution, of course, is to be certain of the gear you bring to Greece, carry plenty of spares and ride conservatively to avoid breaking anything in the first place.

So that pretty much wraps it up for the rule clarifications. Please don't hesitate to get in touch if you have any doubts or questions. The same goes for during the race. You may well have to wait until a town or checkpoint a fair bit further down the road until you can tell us about any issues you had, but please do so. There is some serious satisfaction to be had from knowing that you managed to complete the ride entirely by yourself without any outside assistance.

The Rules

The Hellenic Mountain Race is a race from point A to point B, via a predefined and shared route on a bicycle for solo riders without any dedicated assistance. It's pretty simple really but some people do whatever they can to get one over on the rest of us, so we need some rules.

Put simply, there will be two types of finishes for HMR 2026.

If all **RULES** given below are observed then riders are awarded a **COMPLETION** and are included in the register of **arrivals** which will be listed in time order. Where any reasonable doubt may exist and there is no evidence of a rule breach, then benefit of such doubt is given to the rider.

If, as above, all **RULES** are observed **AND** the conditions for **QUALIFICATION** below are met then riders will be awarded a **CATEGORY FINISH** and be given a finishing position in the **general classification** for solo or pairs as well as being listed in the register of **arrivals**. Where any reasonable doubt may exist and there is no evidence of qualification then the rider will need to prove it.

To summarise: in the presence of doubt Rules compliance is generally assumed, but qualification *must be proved*.

If a category finish is desired it is in the rider's interests to actively avoid doubt.

RULES FOR COMPLIANCE

Here are the rules that **all** riders must meet in order to be awarded a completion and finishing time for the Hellenic Mountain Race.

1. Ride from the designated start line to the designated finish via the route provided and the 3 manned checkpoints listed in this manual and specified on the Brevet Card.
2. No 3rd party support, private lodgings or resupply. All food, drink and equipment must be carried with you or acquired at commercially available services
3. Riders must not solicit any form of private resupply from locals on the race route, any such interaction must be freely offered and unplanned
4. No drafting (other than pairs with their partners)
5. All forward travel overland must be human powered
6. All riders must maintain evidence of their ride
7. Travel insurance, cycle helmets, lights and equipment in the required equipment list are mandatory, we may be checking
8. Riders must know and observe all local traffic laws
9. No private media teams
10. Ride in the spirit of self-reliance and equal opportunity

CONDITIONS FOR QUALIFICATION

Riders will qualify for Solo or Pairs general classification if:

- They begin and finish their race under the same classification
- They remain self-sufficient for the entire duration of their ride
- They validate at controls within the time of operation

NOTES

In order to provide a simple framework for the race this is a simplified set of rules and is therefore open to interpretation. Interpretation for the purposes of race reporting will be made by the race director. The race director's decision is final.

This is a largely self-certified race and it is taken on trust that the ride presented has been ridden in good faith. However, if that trust is found to be broken, for example if the rider is pictured drafting another, dismissal of the offending riders will be swift and definite. You are strongly encouraged to report foul play

in your fellow riders. This should not be viewed as malicious against the rider(s) in question, but a favour and duty to the racing community and in the interest of preserving an honest self-policing racing culture.

Riders should act within the spirit of the rules as well as within the letter of them. This is largely what Rule no.9 means. In the event that a competitor is found to have broken, bent or attempted to circumvent the rules in order to gain an advantage, violations will be taken on a case by case basis. Just because there isn't a rule to cover the specific flavour of deviousness chosen, it doesn't mean a rider will get away with it.

Riders who do not validate at controls within their designated times of operation, by definition exclude themselves from the validation procedure provided by the event. **Riders must understand that if they are not within the time-frame of the checkpoints' operation, they are essentially entirely on their own. It is extremely important to understand this.**

Riders should talk to us. If there's ambiguity in the rules or riders don't know what to do; then they should ask. If you think you did something cheeky but you didn't mean it - tell us, explain why and surely everything will be OK. If you need to make a judgement call, think about the spirit of fair play and doing the right thing, think of the rider behind you and the rider in front, how you would feel if you were them. Tell us what you see. Collect evidence, make a video of your predicament, that kind of thing. The more up front you are, the better.

Pairs riders

In the pairs category, riders in the pair act as a unit and may share food, equipment, information and resources between themselves and help each other including riding in each other's slipstream. No support is to come from outside the pair and resources cannot be shared outside the pair. To all intents and purposes, the pair shall interact with others outside the pair as if they were a solo rider.

Solo and assisted finishes

A solo finish is regarded as a finish 'with honours' and qualifies riders to contest the overall General Classification. [I.e. a rider cannot win the Hellenic Mountain Race if they do not qualify for a solo finish].

Should any rider receive outside assistance from another rider in the race then this is classed as an assisted finish and is not eligible for either Solo or Pairs classification since riders must start and finish under the rules of their classification in order to qualify. The exception for this is that riders can help another rider in an emergency situation on the understanding that the rider who needs help gives up their Brevet Card to the helping rider and scratches from the race. This allows the helping rider to help/rescue a rider in distress and also achieve a Solo Finish. If a rider gets themselves into a situation where they require rescue, but then carry on to the finish, whatever the merits of the ride, they cannot reasonably be said to have completed the Hellenic Mountain Race.

Doctor's Note Checklist

The Hellenic Mountain Race is a serious undertaking that will require a high level of fitness and preparation from participants. It presents a number of specific medical challenges that should not be underestimated. More information on some of the topics that we recommend riders discuss with their doctor can be found below. Please do not wait until the last minute to take care of this. For example, rabies immunisation is given over a 21 to 28 day period.

The doctor's note should clearly show the name of your doctor and medical practice as well as a statement that there are no contrary medical reasons for your participation in the Hellenic Mountain Race. The full name of the event must be present on the note.

- **Rabies**

There is the possibility of rabies from animal bites. Please ask your doctor about rabies prevention including immunisation. This is not obligatory but may be worth exploring.

- **Other Immunizations**

Please check on the appropriate immunizations for travel to the region and ensure that you are up to date on immunizations for tetanus, etc.

- **Basic First Aid/ Medications**

It may be useful to ask your doctor for recommendations on what to include in the basic first aid kit that you are required to bring with you to participate in the race. In addition to your usual personal medications, please discuss whether you should carry other medications such as antibiotics - considering the remote nature of this event.

MEDICAL CERTIFICATE

In order to participate in an ultra cycling event organised by Silk Road Mountain Race LTD, participants must upload the following certificate signed and stamped by a registered doctor prior to registration. The date of issue must be at most 12 months before the last day of the race.

Event Information, please select:

- ☐ Atlas Mountain Race 2026: 1305 KM / +29,400 M
- ☐ Hellenic Mountain Race 2026: 884 KM / +27,900 M
- ☐ Silk Road Mountain Race 2026: 1954 KM / +27,000 M

Date: _____.

First Name: _____.

Last Name: _____.

ID/Passport No: _____.

Signature of participant: _____.

DOCTOR'S INFORMATION

I certify that the above mentioned athlete does not present any contraindication to participate in the above mentioned event.

Doctor's full name: _____.

Doctor's signature: _____.

Stamp of the Doctor:

This medical certificate will be valid for 12 months.